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Business Process Map Template Set

5 Editable Flowchart Templates for Documenting How Work Actually
Moves

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1. What Is Process Mapping & How To Use These Templates

A process map is a visual flowchart that shows how work, decisions, and handoffs move through a business process from start to finish. Where a written SOP documents a procedure step by step in words, a process map documents the same procedure visually — making it easy to spot bottlenecks, missing steps, and unclear ownership at a glance.

This template set includes four fully mapped, real-world processes you can use as a reference or adapt directly, plus one blank template for mapping any process specific to your business. Each mapped template uses the same symbol set defined in the next section, so every diagram in your organization reads the same way regardless of who built it.

How To Use These Templates

- Start by walking the actual process end-to-end with the people who do the work — not how you assume it happens.
- Recreate the box-and-arrow layout in your diagramming tool of choice (Lucidchart, Miro, Visio, or even a whiteboard).
- Use the symbol guide on the next page to stay consistent — a Rectangle is always a task, a Diamond is always a decision.
- Label every box with an action verb ('Verify Payment') rather than a vague noun ('Payment') so the step is unambiguous.
- Add decision points explicitly wherever the process can branch, and label each branch with its condition (e.g., 'Approved' / 'Rejected').
- Review the finished map with everyone who touches the process before treating it as final.

Why Map a Process Before Writing an SOP

Mapping a process visually first, before writing the detailed procedure steps, makes gaps and redundant handoffs obvious in a way a written list often hides. Many teams find that once a process is mapped, the correct sequence of SOP steps writes itself.

2. Process Map Symbols Guide

Use these seven symbols consistently across every process map your team creates. Consistent symbol use is what makes a process map readable by someone outside the team that built it.

Symbol Name	Shape	Meaning
Start/End	Oval	Marks the beginning or end point of a process
Process Step	Rectangle	Represents a single action or task within the workflow
Decision Point	Diamond	Indicates a yes/no or branching decision that changes the path
Flow Direction	Arrow	Shows the sequence and direction that work moves between steps
Document	Document Icon	Represents a form, report, or paper/digital document produced or used
Data Store	Cylinder / Database	Represents stored data, a database, or a records repository
Wait / Delay	D-Shape	Marks a pause, approval wait, or queue before the next step can begin

3. Template 1 — Order-to-Delivery Process Map

This template maps the full lifecycle of a customer order from the moment it is placed to the moment it is closed out internally.



The most important decisions in this process are handling orders that fail payment verification and managing inventory for fulfillment. A second, smaller branch leads to a backorder process.

4. Template 2 — Hiring Process Map

This template maps a standard hiring process from job posting through the new hire's first day of onboarding.



Decision points appear after the Phone Interview, In-Person Interview, and Reference Check steps. Each decision point includes a rejection notification rather than a go/no-go decision before moving forward.

5. Template 3 — Customer Support Ticket Flow

This template maps how a support ticket moves from creation through resolution and final customer feedback.



The Diagnose step includes a Tier 2 Escalation path before the Verify step is itself a decision point. If the customer is not satisfied, the process proceeds to Close, and if

6. Template 4 — Content Publication Process

This template maps a content piece from initial draft through publishing and post-publish performance analysis.



The Review step is a de
back for revisions loops
than the others in this s
represent queued conte

7. Template 5 — Blank Process Map Template

Use this blank template to map any process specific to your business. Recreate the six boxes below in your diagramming tool, connect them with arrows in sequence, and label each box with a single action verb describing that step.



Use the symbols above to fill in your own process steps. Add a Diamond wherever the process branches, a Document icon wherever a form or record is produced, and a Cylinder wherever the step writes to a database or shared system of record.

8. Process Improvement Checklist

Once a process is mapped, use this checklist before redesigning it, so improvements are based on the real current state rather than assumptions.

- ☐ Map the current state before redesigning — document what actually happens, not what should happen.
- ☐ Identify bottlenecks — mark every step where work consistently piles up or waits.
- ☐ Remove redundant steps — cut any step that does not change the outcome or add required approval.
- ☐ Assign clear ownership per step — every box on the map should have exactly one accountable role.
- ☐ Define SLAs for each stage — set a maximum time each step should take before it is considered overdue.
- ☐ Automate repetitive steps where possible — prioritize high-volume, low-judgment steps first.
- ☐ Document exceptions and edge cases — capture what happens when the standard path doesn't apply.
- ☐ Get stakeholder sign-off — confirm every team touched by the process agrees with the redesign.
- ☐ Pilot before full rollout — test the redesigned process on a small scope before deploying company-wide.
- ☐ Review quarterly — revisit every process map at least once a quarter to catch drift from the documented flow.

Keep a copy of every process map alongside its related SOPs in the same shared location, and note the review date directly on the map so it's always clear how current the diagram is.

Need Help?

Our support team is ready to help with questions about this product or your account.

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